Friday 6 November 2026, SLB Championship

London Lions *v* Leicester Riders

19:00

New City College Hackney, Falkirk Street, London N1 6HQ

Venue change: this game is at New City College Hackney, Falkirk Street, London N1 6HQ.

London Lions		Leicester Riders
1st, 8–0	Record	10th, 0–7
W W W W L	Last five	L L L L L
L 84–86 at Maxima Roma, Wed 4 Nov	Last game	L 80–101 v Newcastle Eagles, Fri 30 Oct
Lewis 10.3	Top scorer	Pelote 14.6
Scott 5.3	Rebounds	Johnson 7.1
Jones 4.1	Assists	White 6.1
Lewis 1.7 of 4.0, Horton 1.7 of 3.9	Threes a game	Hurley 2.0 of 5.3
Jones 1.7	Steals	Pelote 0.9
71	Last meeting	66

Eight from eight in the SLB, the Lions return from Rome with a point to prove and a winless Leicester side at New City College Hackney. The league leaders sit top of the table; the Riders are still looking for their first win of the campaign.

Wednesday's EuroCup trip ended in an 86–84 overtime defeat, and the Lions are back at home in the league three days later.

Form *8–0 in the SLB, a close one lost in Rome*

The Lions came from 31–15 down after the first quarter to beat Sheffield 85–76 last Friday and move to 8–0. Maxwell Lewis III scored 20 with four threes from six, and Devante Jones added 12 points and eight assists. Head coach Tautvydas Sabonis said: “The second, third, and fourth quarter we played our basketball, the problem was our first quarter.”

In Rome on Wednesday they led 44–42 at the break, fell 13 behind in the third and fought back to level at 76 when Lewis converted an and-one with 25.3 seconds left. Roma won it in overtime, 86–84, and the Lions finished 10-for-23 from the free-throw line. “We missed some open shots, and if I'm not mistaken, we missed 15 free throws, maybe even 20 free throws, in a game you lose in overtime,” said Sabonis.

Wed 4 Nov EuroCup at Maxima Roma	L 84–86
Fri 30 Oct SLB v Sheffield Sharks	W 85–76
Wed 28 Oct EuroCup v Turk Telekom Ankara	W 79–61
Sat 24 Oct SLB v Bristol Flyers	W 82–76
Wed 21 Oct EuroCup at U-BT Cluj-Napoca	W 89–72

Highlights

HEARTBREAK ON THE ROAD AS LIONS COME UP SHORT IN ROME Wed 4 Nov

LONDON LIONS EUROCUP POST GAME SHOW VS TÜRK TELEKOM Fri 30 Oct

Lions roster *and who to watch*

Maxwell Lewis III
Season: 10.3 pts, 3.4 reb, 1.0 ast, 19 min

The Lions' leading scorer on 10.3 points a game. He scored 14 in Rome, including the and-one that forced overtime.

Devante Jones
Season: 9.7 pts, 1.1 reb, 4.1 ast, 20 min

Leads the team in assists and steals. He had 13 points and seven assists in Rome and eight assists against Sheffield.

Thomas Kennedy
Season: 10.1 pts, 4.3 reb, 2.0 ast, 18 min

The centre scores 10.1 points a game. He set up a Lewis corner three against Sheffield and scored 10 that night.

Joel Scott
Season: 9.7 pts, 5.3 reb, 1.4 ast, 22 min

Leads the Lions in rebounds. He finished with 11 points and five rebounds in Rome, and his put-back cut the overtime deficit to two.

Ethan Price
Season: 9.5 pts, 3.9 reb, 1.3 ast, 17 min

Scored 12 in Rome and hit a three to start the fourth quarter against Sheffield.

Tarik Phillip
Season: 7.7 pts, 3.7 reb, 2.7 ast, 20 min

Described by the Riders' preview as the reigning SLB Defensive Player of the Year.

Full roster

1	Joel Scott	C/F
2	Maxwell Lewis III	F
3	Devante Jones	G
6	Morayo Soluade	F
7	Joshua O'Garro	F
8	Emilis Zibuda	F
10	Ethan Price	C/F

21	Aaryn Rai	F
22	Tarik Phillip	G
23	Landrius Horton	F/G
31	Deane Williams	C/F
54	Thomas Kennedy	C

Leicester Riders *winless, 0–7*

Leicester are tenth, 0–7, and have lost their last five. The latest was a 101–80 defeat at Newcastle, where they trailed 48–38 at half-time and could not close the gap despite a third-quarter push. Before that came a 107–102 defeat at Surrey and an 89–87 defeat by Manchester.

Coach Paternostro's side is new and young, with six rookies adapting to professional basketball, according to the club's preview.

Jaylon White

Season: 10.9 pts, 2.9 reb, 6.1 ast, 28 min

The rookie point guard, known as JJ, averages 6.1 assists, which the club says is the second-highest mark in the league. He had 13 points and seven assists against Newcastle.

Bernard Pelote

Season: 14.6 pts, 5.1 reb, 1.3 ast, 31 min

The Riders' leading scorer on 14.6 points a game. He had 15 points and 15 rebounds against the Lions at the Copper Box.

Deante Johnson Jr

Season: 11.6 pts, 7.1 reb, 2.0 ast, 28 min

The centre leads Leicester in rebounds on 7.1 a game and adds 11.6 points.

Taryn Todd

Season: 12.9 pts, 3.0 reb, 3.0 ast, 23 min

Scores 12.9 points a game in 23 minutes.

Thomas Hurley

Season: 11.3 pts, 3.4 reb, 1.9 ast, 23 min

Averages 11.3 points and makes 2 of his 5.3 three-point attempts a game.

Last five

Fri 30 Oct SLB v Newcastle Eagles	L 80–101
Fri 23 Oct SLB v Manchester Basketball	L 87–89
Sat 17 Oct SLB at Surrey 89ers	L 102–107
Sun 11 Oct SLB at Sheffield Sharks	L 75–85
Fri 9 Oct SLB v Bristol Flyers	L 73–78

Full roster

null	Tristan Curran	C
null	Moziah King Danchie	F/G
null	Stephen Ovia	G
1	Jaylon White	G
3	Bernard Pelote	F
5	Callum Lawson	G
6	Taryn Todd	G
8	Oscar Curran	G
8	Trent Donald MacDonnell Johnson	F
9	Thomas Hurley	G
10	Julian Mackey	G
13	Blair Thompson	F
25	Victor Ndoukou	F

35	Deante Johnson Jr	C
36	Tomide Akinsiku	F
43	Seth Wylie	G

Things to watch

- **The free-throw line.** The Lions were 10-for-23 in Rome and lost by two in overtime.
- **Pelote against the Lions' bigs.** Leicester's club preview says his rebounding and finishing will be vital in challenging London's physicality.
- **Playmakers.** White averages 6.1 assists to Jones's 4.1.
- **A better start.** Sheffield led 31–15 after a quarter last Friday. Sabonis called the first quarter “the problem”.

Head to head *71–66 at the Copper Box*

2 Oct 2026 SLB Copper Box Arena	W 71–66

The sides met on 2 October, and the Lions won 71–66. Leicester's club says they narrowly missed out despite a spirited fourth-quarter fightback.

League table

The Lions lead on 16 points from eight played, ahead of second-placed Newcastle on 12 points from nine played. Leicester are bottom of the

ten teams with no points from seven.

#	Team	P	W	L	Pts
1	**London Lions**	**8**	**8**	**0**	**16**
2	Newcastle Eagles	9	6	3	12
3	Manchester Basketball	9	5	4	10
4	Bristol Flyers	8	4	4	8
5	Sheffield Sharks	6	3	3	6
6	Caledonia Gladiators	6	3	3	6
7	Cheshire Phoenix	7	3	4	6
8	Liverpool Basketball	8	3	5	6
9	Surrey 89ers	6	2	4	4
10	**Leicester Riders**	**7**	**0**	**7**	**0**

Notable stats

- Lewis and Horton each average 1.7 made threes a game, on 4 and 3.9 attempts.
- Jones averages 1.7 steals, the most in the squad.
- Lewis leads the scoring on 10.3, with Kennedy on 10.1 and Scott and Jones on 9.7 each.
- Leicester's scoring leader, Pelote, averages 14.6 points.

What's next

The Lions host Reyer Venice in the EuroCup on Tuesday, then Surrey 89ers at the Copper Box on Friday.

Tue 10 Nov, 19:30 EuroCup v Reyer Venice

Fri 13 Nov, 19:30 SLB v Surrey 89ers

Tue 17 Nov, 19:30 EuroCup v Siauliai

Fri 20 Nov, 19:30 SLB at Sheffield Sharks

Sources

Genius Sports (SLB)

SLB Championship standings

Lions roster

Leicester Riders summary

Leicester Riders roster

Lions player statistics

Leicester Riders player statistics

Lions SLB Championship fixtures and results

EuroLeague

EuroCup games

YouTube

London Lions channel feed

Leicester Riders

Riders face league-leading London Lions in the Capital, 4 Nov 2026

Eagles pull away in the second to defeat Riders., 31 Oct 2026

London Lions

LIONS FALL 86-84 IN OVERTIME TO MAXIMA ROMA ON THE ROAD, 4 Nov 2026

LONDON LIONS FIGHT BACK TO BEAT SHEFFIELD SHARKS 85-76 AND EXTEND UNBEATEN SLB RUN, 30 Oct 2026

Gathered 6 Nov 2026 at 08:18.